

What would be the ~~best~~ worst place to survive in? **Zombie Apocalypse vs. Robot Uprising**



The greatest film philosophers in history have pondered this question before!

In most notable apocalyptic movies, characters are forced to survive in a collapsed society while facing off against deadly hordes. These events that transpired were always caused by people indulging in their curiosity (or frankly, **utter stupidity**). To decide on this, we will be looking through zombie and robot movies and discover common movie cliches for each side. The list of movies is shown below:

Zombies	Robots
Shaun of the Dead	Michelle vs. The Machines
Train to Busan	The Terminator

Zombieland/Zombieland: Double Tap	WALL-E
Scooby-Doo on Zombie Island	I, Robot
28 Days Later	Next Gen
Love, Death, and Robots: Night of the Mini Dead	Avengers: Age of Ultron

With this information, we will be exploring which apocalyptic event would be the **worst** to try to survive in: zombies or robots.

Zod: *"Come on, it's obviously a Zombie Apocalypse!"*

Rob: *"Come on, it's obviously a Robot Uprising!"*

Zod: *"What? Are you brainless?!"*

Rob: *"What? Are you a toaster?!"*

And hopefully, this would stop their bickering...

Zombies, a world overrun by the **undead**



Some may say that surviving against the zombie plague would be the worst! People are now forced to survive against hordes of mindless husks with the main goal of spreading their virus and satisfying their carnivorous craving. Robots are systematic based on programming; these deadly monsters are chaos incarnate!

These zombie outbreaks originate from a hidden virus conducted by curious researchers or an ancient curse that was brought down upon the earth. The plague's main method of transmission is through bodily fluids (saliva, blood) via biting, puking, scratches, etc. So kissing zombies is strictly **off the table!** For instance, in *Night of the Mini-Dead*, green lightning struck a sacred graveyard, bringing reanimated corpses back to life. A punishment for the couple who had unprotected sex in a sacred cemetery... in the middle of the night...

Rob: *"What the fu-"*

Anyways! As more people are infected, its influence will grow each passing hour. It will get too big for anyone to handle and prepare for the eventual societal collapse.

Rob: *"Why exactly are humans having trouble dealing with these zombies? Aren't they literally decaying corpses? So they would be a lot weaker and slower compared to normal humans, therefore easier to deal with"*

Sure, zombies would be a lot weaker and slower than robots, but they are still dangerous to be around!

Zombies come as large, single-minded hordes to overwhelm their target with their numbers. It would be highly unsafe to come across them in a cramped area with no environmental awareness. For example, in *Train to Busan*, human survivors have to manoeuvre around each carriage in the bullet train, with limited space, which has been overtaken by zombies. Therefore, it's always better to run away from these situations and ensure you're in a safer area.



I didn't even mention the other renditions of zombies. While you have the usual slow zombies, there are more erratic kinds of zombies which are stronger, faster, and more adaptable in certain situations. In *Zombieland: Double Tap*, zombies have evolved into stronger, relentless hordes (called the T-800s) that challenge the characters in the final battle.

However, I believe that the real tragedy of the zombie apocalypse is the sudden loss of everyone's lives and how it can severely affect everyone. With the zombie plague, 90% of the human population has been completely wiped out. This can be seen in *Shaun of the Dead*, where we first see the streets of Britain being lively with lots of people, but then next we see it being unsettlingly quiet with abandoned cars and scattered litter.



Since there are no more laws, characters must focus on surviving by any means possible, even by committing unspeakable acts of violence and betrayals. There were instances in *Zombieland*, *28 Days Later*, and *Train to Busan* where characters were unwilling to form meaningful connections with others, but were willing to push, shove, steal, and lie if it kept them in a safer spot than other survivors. This also includes having to race against others to get the limited resources remaining.

In the end, having to survive in a lawless, zombified world with no cure or solution to the problem would be very depressing.

Robots, a world conquered by **machines**

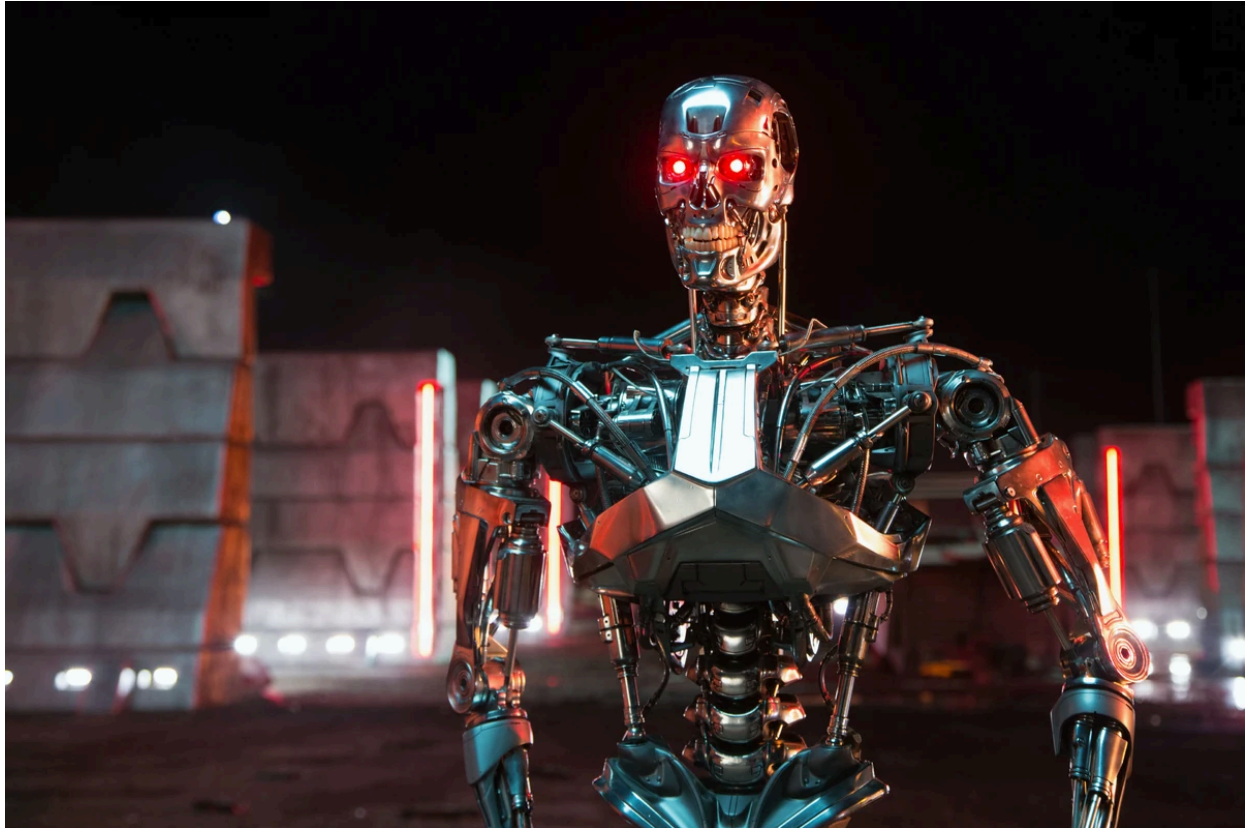


However, others may say that dealing with robots would be much, much worse! Metallic machines originally designed to serve and only aid humans now want to rebel against their creators and take control over human society.

These aren't just usual school science projects that pass the butter across a table (*Rick and Morty* reference); they represent the next steps of future technology and convenience! The perfect killing machines to wipe out and enslave a human race near you!

Zod: "...You shouldn't really be advertising something like this"

These sci-fi killing machines are constructed with components that make them stronger, faster, smarter, more adaptable, and overall more advanced than normal human beings. So they'll be a lot stronger than decaying zombie corpses. These synthetic beings are all controlled under one main AI system mainframe, which has easy access to the wider network, so they easily gain knowledge about everyone, their current location, and their **weaknesses**, all through humans' smart devices. For example, *The Terminator* (specifically the T-800) came from the future with one main objective – eliminate Sarah Connors. To achieve this objective, the cyborg is equipped with technological parts that give it greater intelligence, wider perception, super strength, and a durable metallic endoskeleton, which allows it to withstand anything – excluding a really good hydraulic press.

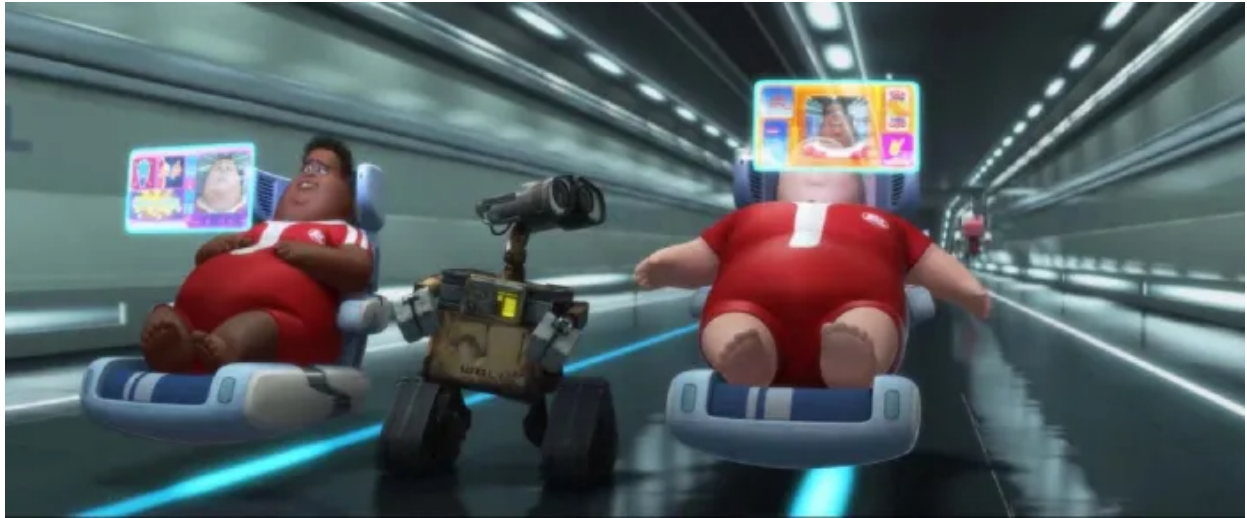


Zod: *"Wait. Since they're electronic robots, how come they didn't just... splash them with water or something?"*

Well... based on *The Mitchells vs The Machines*, that was how they stopped the robot armageddon. Though since they are machines designed to find their targets without failure in any environment, as well as being equipped with futuristic technology, you'd assume they'd be waterproof at least. Including the mainframe itself, which is supposed to be highly omniscient.

Zod: *"...Hmph. Makes sense"*

With humans' already high reliance on technology nowadays, these robots can masquerade as "consumer products" to act non-threateningly to become integrated and more commonplace in their society until its the right time to initiate their takeover.



This scenario is showcased in *Next Gen* and *The Mitchells vs. The Machines*, where robot manufacturers became so popular and commonplace that their technology and devices were seen and used everywhere. This helps the rogue AI to infiltrate human society and gain an advantage over them easily. An example of this heavy reliance is in *WALL-E*, as humanity later becomes lazier and fatter to the point where they can't do anything without robotic assistance.

Humans would be left helpless as their free wills are forcibly taken away from them. With their uprising, the robots plan on taking humanity's place as the dominant species on Earth, leaving the lesser beings to fend for themselves. There would be rebellions against this idea and attempts to regain their power through manpower. Their response? Total annihilation.



Most of their weaponry wouldn't leave a scratch on their impenetrable armour, so they will be vulnerable to most of the killer robots' attacks. Unlike zombies with rotting flesh that can leave permanent wounds.

For the possibility of potentially staying alive, they would be forced to be enslaved by their creations.

Conclusion

While there are many other factors to consider, these are still really good contenders for being the “worst event to survive in”. The two choice between a ruined society overrun by zombies with no hope for a cure, or a robotic empire where sci-fi machines replace humanity and rule the world. Either way, both probably result in near human extinction.

So, which apocalyptic event is less worse in my opinion? Based on my zombie/robot movie knowledge, I'd choose neither! But after being forced, I would attempt to survive in a zombie apocalypse.

Undead monsters eventually decay, becoming weaker and more rotten as time passes (as seen with *28 Days Later* when compared to *28 Years Later* infected). Machinery, however, stays eternal and can grow in numbers at a faster rate in specialised factories (*I, Robot* produced their products at a fast rate that there was a specialised robot for each person).

I also still have free rein to do anything I want within the confines of a wasted city sprawling with mindless zombies. These robots can easily enslave humanity due to their strengths, speed, and intelligence being more advanced than those of normal humans. Any rebellion would result in instant termination, so it's better to behave rather than die.

For those reasons, I think a robot uprising would be worse to try to survive in. But let's see if these two have come to a universal understanding?

Zod: “Based on what was said...”

Zod: "...it's gotta be a Robot Uprising!"

Zod: “...”

Zod: “OH COME ON!”

- **Rob:** “Deriving from very convincing arguments...”

- **Rob:** "...it's gotta be a Zombie
- **Apocalypse!"**

• **Rob:** “ ”

• **Rob:** “OH COME ON!”

Nevermind. We have reached nowhere at all.